CALDAS

A TOWN OF MAKERS

Investor Guide 2026 · Caldas da Rainha, Portugal

Inventing since 1485.
Come and create with us.

A HISTORY OF INNOVATION

INVENTING SINCE 1485

1485

Queen Leonor founds the thermal hospital considered the oldest in the world.

19th c.

Rafael Bordallo Pinheiro makes ceramics smile for the world. UNESCO Creative City since 2019.

Today

Drones, award-winning design and the European Capital of Small Retail 2026.

AT A GLANCE

CALDAS DA RAINHA IN NUMBERS

58,983
residents (2025), +11.6% since 2021

8,041
establishments (2022)

€1.86bn
business turnover (2023)

≈1 h
drive to Lisbon, traffic dependent

≈400
people at Tekever’s engineering centre

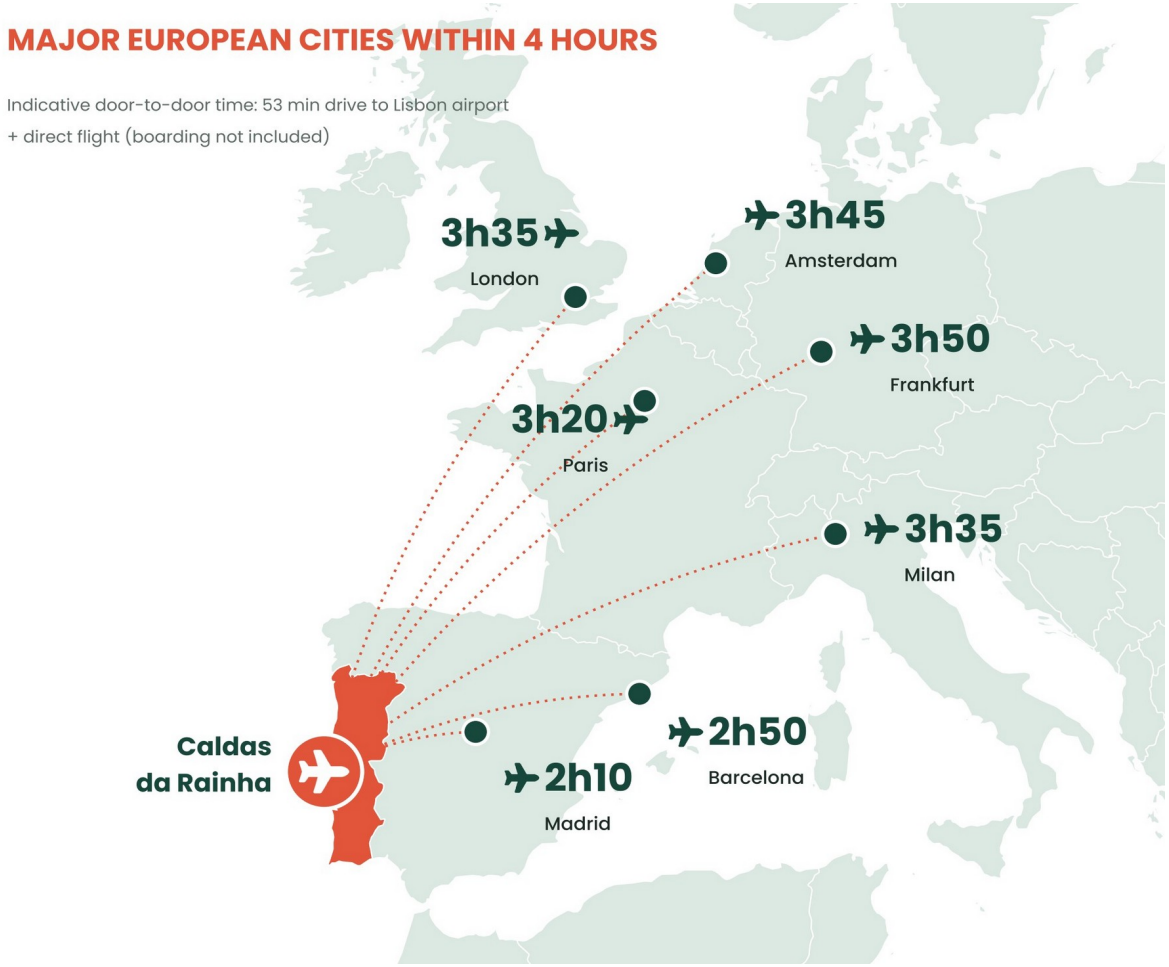
1,600
art and design students (ESAD.CR)

116 kt
Pera Rocha in the Oeste region (2025)

2026
European Capital of Small Retail

LOCATION

WESTERN PORTUGAL, AN HOUR FROM LISBON





≈1 h

Lisbon via the A8

≈1 h

Lisbon airport

≈40 min

Leiria

Driving times depend on traffic. Oeste railway upgrades are under way.



Fábrica Bordallo Pinheiro · GualdimG · CC BY-SA 4.0

RECOGNISED CREATIVITY

A TOWN OF MAKERS

UNESCO

Creative City since 2019 — Crafts and Folk Art

2026

European Capital of Small Retail — Vibrant City category

Bordallo Pinheiro showed the way: humour, satire and industry. An identity that gives character to products, brands and experiences.

DESIGN-LED INDUSTRY

DESIGN MEETS PRODUCTION CAPABILITY

≈500
people at Schaeffler, almost all output exported

€1.86bn
municipal business turnover (2023)

€130m
goods exports (2023)

911
establishments in the industry, creativity and innovation cluster (2022)

Ceramics, metalworking, automotive components, boilers and food manufacturing: a diverse base, with the Martin Group and Schaeffler making things here for the world.



TEKEVER AR3 (RAF) · illustrative, not in Caldas · Crown copyright · OGL v3

DEFENCE AND AEROSPACE

ENGINEERING THAT FLIES

Tekever — a Portuguese unicorn headquartered in Lisbon — runs its engineering centre in Caldas and designs around 90% of its AR5 drone here.

>€1.2bn

valuation (2025)

≈400 → 700

announced expansion, subject to delivery

≈20%

of Portugal’s defence exports are drones

FROM CONCEPT TO PRODUCT

ESAD.CR

≈1,600 art and design students; LiDA lab rated «Excellent»

HEALTH CAMPUS

University of Leiria and Oeste: 80 students, 4 programmes, since 6 Oct 2026

CENCAL · CENFIM

Training for ceramics, glass and metalworking

UPCALDAS

14 offices and 20 coworking desks, opened June 2026

260 g wine bottle (LiDA + Santos Barosa): two Red Dot awards in 2026. Prontos and SILOS: creative communities to start with.

RETAIL AND SERVICES

PEOPLE IN THE STREETS

Vibrant City 2026

European Capital of Small Retail

Praça da Fruta, street retail and cultural life. The Commercial District includes digital and training initiatives. Confirm which services are currently operational.

883

retail outlets (2022)

38

listings on 9 Oct, availability to reconfirm



Praça da Fruta · Pedro Ribeiro Simões · CC BY 2.0

LOCAL MARKET

A GROWING TOWN

58,983

residents in 2025 · +6,111 (+11.6%) since 2021

8,041
establishments (2022)

1,071
homes licensed (2025)

207,225
tourist nights (2023)

HEALTH AND WELLBEING

THE TOWN BORN FROM A HOSPITAL

1485

Thermal Hospital, considered the oldest in the world

80

students at the new ULO Health campus (Oct 2026)

2027

CUF clinic expected to open

Rehabilitation, active ageing and wellbeing; a new thermal bathhouse being planned.



Lago do Parque D. Carlos I · Senhormario · CC BY-SA 4.0



Praça da Fruta · Pedro Ribeiro Simões · CC BY 2.0

AGRI-FOOD

AT THE HEART OF PORTUGAL'S ORCHARD

116 kt

Pera Rocha in the Oeste region (2025)

70%

exported to 20 countries

84%

of Portugal's pear orchards are in the Oeste

1978

Frutos — National Fruit and Vegetable Fair

HOUSING

A GROWING TOWN NEEDS HOMES

1,071

homes licensed in 2025 (+30%)

€1,704/m²

median bank valuation (2025)

+21.5%

valuation growth in 2025, ahead of the Oeste

Mid-market, build-to-rent, historic-centre regeneration and student residences.



Parque D. Carlos I · Alexey Komarov · CC BY 4.0

EXPLORE THE OPPORTUNITY

FIVE WAYS IN



01

RETAIL & SERVICES

Europe’s small-retail capital



02

HEALTH & WELLBEING

From thermal heritage to a Health campus



03

DEFENCE & AEROSPACE

Engineering that flies



04

AGRO

At the heart of Pera Rocha



05

HOUSING

A growing town needs homes

SPACE FOR YOUR PROJECT

FROM A SHOPFRONT TO INDUSTRIAL PREMISES

A01

CIDADE INDUSTRIAL AREA

155.7 ha current
304.9 ha proposed

A02

CASAL DE SANTA CECÍLIA

25.7 ha current
28.5 ha proposed

A03

SÃO GREGÓRIO

11.2 ha current / 61.4 ha proposed
A8, Fanadia junction

A04

SANTA CATARINA

18.7 ha current
24.1 ha proposed

400
hectares in the current PDM

586
hectares in the proposed revision

+46%
proposed increase, subject to approval

Municipal survey, 19 Oct 2026. Planning areas are not available plots. Proposed revision subject to approval.

COSTS THAT HELP

MUNICIPAL TAXES AND INVESTMENT SUPPORT

0.33%
municipal surtax on taxable profit (2025)

5 years
new firms and 3+ jobs maintained, subject to conditions

0.30%
reference property tax, confirm tax year

3%
reference income tax share, confirm year

Annual taxes and exemptions require confirmation. Portugal 2030 eligibility depends on the call and project.

SOFTLANDING

YOUR FIRST 14 DAYS



D0

Enquiry and language

48 h

Useful answer and your manager

D2–D4

Qualification meeting

D5–D9

Joined-up technical screening

D10–D14

Action plan or site visit

Ongoing

Ongoing support

Model subject to Council approval: contact, deputy and 48-hour calculation. Timelines concern support, not permits or property availability.

WHAT WOULD YOU LIKE TO BUILD HERE?



Caldas da Rainha City Council
economia@mcr.pt
Praça 25 de Abril, 2500-110 Caldas da Rainha
+351 262 240 000

Share your activity, space, investment, jobs and timetable. Ask for a named contact and agreed next steps.

CALDAS DA RAINHA · INVESTOR KIT

Caldas Ready-to-Invest

From first contact to a concrete plan in 14 days

48h	1	1	14 days
first useful reply	dedicated contact	joined-up municipal answer	to an action plan

01 YOUR SOFTLANDING JOURNEY

1 → **2** → **3** → **4**

DAY 0–1
Welcome
We confirm receipt and introduce your dedicated contact.

DAY 2–4
Scope
We map your project, needs and timeline.

DAY 5–9
Connect
We link you to licensing, sites, talent and funding.

DAY 10–14
Plan
You receive an action plan or site visit.

02 WHAT YOU RECEIVE

Municipal fact sheet	Map of land and buildings	Tax and incentives package	14-day softlanding guide	Local ecosystem contacts	Investor case studies	Tailored dossier

public information

dedicated information, under NDA if needed →

03 AFTER YOU LAND: ONGOING SUPPORT

GERAI MUNICIPALITIES

WELCOME
A welcome, a useful contact and clear next steps.

KNOW
Your company's profile, needs and projects.

MOBILISE
Alerts on funding, spaces, talent and partners.

Your first 14 days

One dedicated contact.
A coordinated municipal response.
An action plan or site visit.

Proposed service model, subject to municipal validation. Support targets are not licensing deadlines.

economia@mcr.pt

Caldas da Rainha · NEXTGROUP